

Short-Handed Indians Hand Bears Short End

By Special Correspondent

DENVER—For two years all that American Association players talked about here was how the ball would carry in Denver's mile-high atmosphere.

Now, strange as it may seem, they are wondering why their long drives aren't going out of the park like they used to.

"Did they move the light air out?" Indianapolis Coach Johnny Hutchings inquired as he helped Manager Andy Cohen discuss the whys and wherefores of Indianapolis' highly satisfying 8-2 conquest of the Denver Bears last night.

Andy, who knows all about Denver's light air after four years as Denver's Western League skipper from 1951-54, said he noticed the ball wasn't carrying like it used to.

"But I didn't think that last fly of Wilson's (George) was going nearly as far as it did before (Ted) Beard caught it close to the fence," Andy added quickly.

"That's right, Andy, but I know darn well some of those other balls would have been out of here last year," Hutchings snapped back. "Like that one (Marv) Throneberry hit in the last inning."

A half hour earlier Throne-

berry was grumbling about the same thing in the Denver clubhouse.

"I don't understand it," Throneberry mumbled. "I'd bet that ball would have been out of any park in the league and the guy (Jim Delsing) still backed up against the fence and caught it. And that one the night before I hit just as good."

"I hit those balls as good as any I hit on the road trip when I got three homers," Marv concluded.

Throneberry failed to mention that both flies were caught at the 380-foot mark in right center.

A bystander offered two possible explanations. There has been a vast overabundance of precipitation in Denver this spring, making the air much more resistant to flying baseballs. And the wind has been blowing against the batters most of the time, sometimes at brisk velocity.

But last night the humidity was down to 17% and the flag hung limp on the centerfield flagpole after a brief pregame shower. As a team, the Bears hit nine homers in three games on the road and only four in five games since coming home.

These were the unusual

home-run figures by parks as of Wednesday:

	Home	Visitors	Total
Indianapolis ..	5	9	14
St. Paul	4	8	12
Omaha	6	5	11
Louisville	1	8	9
Charleston ...	4	5	9
Minneapolis ..	4	4	8
Wichita	5	3	8
Denver	4	4	8

Cohen hoped to be able to start big Barry Latman against Denver's lefty John Gebhard tonight but wasn't certain.

"He's got a jammed finger and he's complaining about a strep throat, too," Andy said. "I just don't know. I'll probably wind up starting (Don) Rudolph."

Andy, fretting over the ailments keeping Sam Mele (bad back) and Charley Williams (strep throat) out of action, was particularly happy over Bill DuFour's slick five-hit mound job in his first start last night, and he put in a good word for Dick DiTusa, who smacked three singles and kept both of Indianapolis' scoring innings going.

It takes a home-run club to stay up with the American Association these days. A new outburst of circuit shots echoed last night as Wichita pulled a game farther ahead with a 6-4 triumph over second-place Omaha last night.

Homers by Joe Koppe and Bob Hazle helped the Braves, who needed a double play to beat back Omaha's ninth-inning rally. All of the Cardinals' runs were delivered by Jerry Geiger, who smacked a homer in the fourth and another, with two on, in the eighth.

Five homers were hit at St. Paul where the Saints beat Charleston, 13-9. The Senator's George Risley clouted his with the bases loaded in the fourth.

At Minneapolis, a two-run homer by Orlando Cepeda in the seventh broke a 6-6 tie and powered Minneapolis' 12-8 victory over Louisville.

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION STANDINGS

	Won	Lost	Pct.	GB
Wichita	9	3	.750	
Omaha	9	4	.600	1 1/2
St. Paul	8	6	.571	2
Denver	5	4	.556	2 1/2
Minneapolis ..	7	7	.500	3
Charleston ..	7	8	.467	3 1/2
INDIANAPOLIS ..	5	9	.357	5
Louisville	2	9	.182	6 1/2

LAST NIGHT'S RESULTS

Wichita	020	021	010-6	12 0
Omaha	000	100	030-4	6 1
Jay, Ross (9), Paine (9) and Atwell; McClain, Linker (7), Schultz (9) and Command.				
WP-Jay. LP-McClain.				
HR-Wichita: Koppe, Hazle; Omaha: Geiger 2.				
Louisville	120	300	002-	8 11 1
Minneapolis ..	010	022	34x-12	12 3
Murzewski, Fisher (6), Frauts (8), Brown (8) and Rapp; Corwin, Shipley (4) and Schmidt.				
WP-Shipley. LP-Fisher.				
HR-Minneapolis: Gater, Cepeda.				
Charleston	120	600	000-	9 7 1
St. Paul	114	004	03x-13	14 1
Daniel, Nicholas (3), Harrington (6), Lewis (8) and Griffin; Templeton, Hribar (4), Wegner (4), Scott (5), McDewitt (7) and Howell, Sherry.				
WP-Scott. LP-Harrington.				

TRIBE BOX SCORE

INDIANAPOLIS (8)										
	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E			
Prohovich, 3b.....	5	0	1	2	0	1	0			
Garcia, 2b.....	4	0	1	0	3	3	0			
Jackson, 1b.....	2	1	1	0	13	0	0			
Delsing, rf.....	3	1	0	1	1	0	0			
Beard, cf.....	5	0	1	1	3	0	0			
DiTusa, lf.....	5	0	2	3	3	0	0			
Hairman, c.....	4	0	2	2	3	0	0			
Valdivia, ss.....	4	0	0	2	0	5	0			
DuFour, p.....	3	1	0	1	1	1	0			
	35	3	8	12	27	10	0			
DENVER (2)										
	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E			
Roberts, 2b.....	4	0	1	1	1	7	0			
Wilson, rf.....	4	0	0	0	2	1	0			
Siebert, lf.....	3	1	0	1	3	0	0			
Bello, cf.....	4	0	0	0	3	0	0			
Throneberry, 1b ..	3	1	0	0	11	1	0			
Blanchard, c.....	4	0	0	0	0	2	0			
Sanders, 2b.....	2	0	0	0	2	0	0			
Brickell, ss.....	3	0	1	2	5	4	0			
Urban, p.....	0	0	0	0	0	0	1			
Gabler, p.....	2	0	0	1	0	2	0			
aHassell.....	1	0	0	0	0	0	0			
Lewright, p.....	0	0	0	0	0	0	0			
	30	2	2	5	27	20	1			
aHit into double play for Gabler in 7th.										
Indianapolis.....	500	000	300-8							
Denver	002	000	000-2							
Runs batted in-Delsing, Beard, DiTusa, Hairman 2, Valdivia 2, Roberts, Siebert.										